

VAMAC Employee Experience Platform

PROPOSAL · BUILD ENGAGEMENT · PHASE 1

VAMAC, INC.

VAMAC, Inc. — 179 associates · 24 locations · since 1915

INITIAL RECOMMENDATION · MAY 1, 2026

An operating system for how VAMAC develops people.

Lifecycle-aware HR dashboard. Purpose-built LMS that replaces BlueVolt and the Epicor LMS rework. SOP capture from interview transcripts. Built around how VAMAC's culture actually works — and structured as the second pillar of the platform foundation that runs every AI tool VAMAC will build.

PREPARED FOR

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THE OPPORTUNITY

The build the VAMAC team can grow into.

On April 13, three different conversations happened in the same hour. Emily walked through how she tracks forklift, CPR, and compliance certifications across folders by branch — a mix of paper and electronic, no purpose-fit system because BlueVolt did not work out and the Epicor LMS required heavy rework. Suzanne sketched a lifecycle-aware HR dashboard concept that gives field managers one view and HR leadership another, anchored on milestones across every associate's journey. And the underlying workforce reality came up: roughly **10% of associates are age 64 or older**. Recent retirements have already taken decades of operating knowledge.

At first these looked like three problems. They are one problem — all about **how VAMAC develops, supports, and inherits its people**. The same lifecycle data that powers the HR dashboard drives the LMS curriculum. The same senior-associate interviews that capture SOPs preserve knowledge before it walks out the door. One platform, three connected modules.

WHAT WE HEARD

Suzanne, Apr 17 email: "The dashboard would ideally allow managers to view individual and team-level progress at a glance, identify overdue or incomplete milestones, track trends across regions or branches, improve accountability and follow-through on HR processes." Lauren's Apr 17 notes: "Short-form is the unlock. 5-minute videos or snippets — 'here's a faucet, here's how you solve it.'" Apr 13: AI policy went out in March, but no formal training for regionals or branch managers yet.

Why this is the right build for VAMAC to co-author

This is the more approachable of the two flagship builds, and that is the point. The HR Dashboard pattern is well-understood. The LMS pattern is well-understood. Transcript-to-SOP is mostly orchestration on top of established models. There is no novel computer vision, no edge-case-heavy inference. The technical surface is one VAMAC IT can be hands-on with from **Day 1** — pairing with Tenexity engineers, reviewing every PR, owning a manufacturer integration end-to-end. This is where the team builds the muscle that lets them author their own AI applications independently once Phase 1 ships.

And the problem is meaningful. The 10%-of-the-workforce-age-64-plus reality means the next two years will see substantial knowledge departures. Suzanne's dashboard concept is the most concrete vision we've heard from any leader. Emily's compliance work is real-money risk. The build solves problems VAMAC actually has, with patterns the VAMAC team can carry forward.

It is also less expensive than septic because the infrastructure carries over — Microsoft Entra ID identity, hosting, deployment pipeline, Microsoft 365 integration, and the Eclipse integration for role and branch hierarchy are already standing. The only net-new integrations EE needs are **ADP** and **the manufacturer training portals**. Both builds together complete the platform foundation; either alone gets you most of the way there.

OVERVIEW · HOW IT WORKS

A regional manager's morning. Suzanne's Monday review. Emily's compliance check.

A walkthrough — three users, three flows — of what the platform looks like in normal operation, after Phase 1 has shipped. Each user sees the data they should see, structured around the work they actually do.

A regional manager opens the dashboard at 7:30am

Lands on the manager view. Top-of-screen: 4 cards — overdue cert renewals (3), missed 30/60/90 check-ins (1), action plans needing review (2), new hires this week (1). Below: a roster of every associate in the region, with status dots. Click into Trent at the Mechanicsville branch — sees Trent's profile: tenure 18 months, last review 4 months ago, growth plan 50% complete, all certs current, 2 manufacturer trainings pending. Decide to schedule a 30-minute conversation. Click "schedule check-in" — Outlook pops with a draft invite. Done in 6 minutes.

Suzanne does her Monday leadership review

Lands on the leadership view. Top: turnover rate by region (year-over-year trend), time-to-productive for new hires, certification compliance %, growth-plan completion rate. Drills into the South region — turnover spiked 4 points last quarter. Filters to associates who left within their first 12 months — 3 of them. Sees the common thread (no completed 30-day check-in). Sends a note to the regional manager. Adds an item to the next leadership meeting.

Emily handles compliance for the morning

Inbox view of the LMS module. Three certs expiring in the next 30 days at three different branches — system has already pre-drafted email reminders. She approves and sends. A new associate started Monday — system has auto-assigned the onboarding curriculum (forklift, AI policy, CPR, branch safety walk). Emily reviews the assignment, confirms. Two manufacturer trainings (Bradford White, A.O. Smith) just published new modules — system has automatically routed them to associates who carry those product lines. Done.

A senior associate sits for 60 minutes with Suzanne and an interviewer

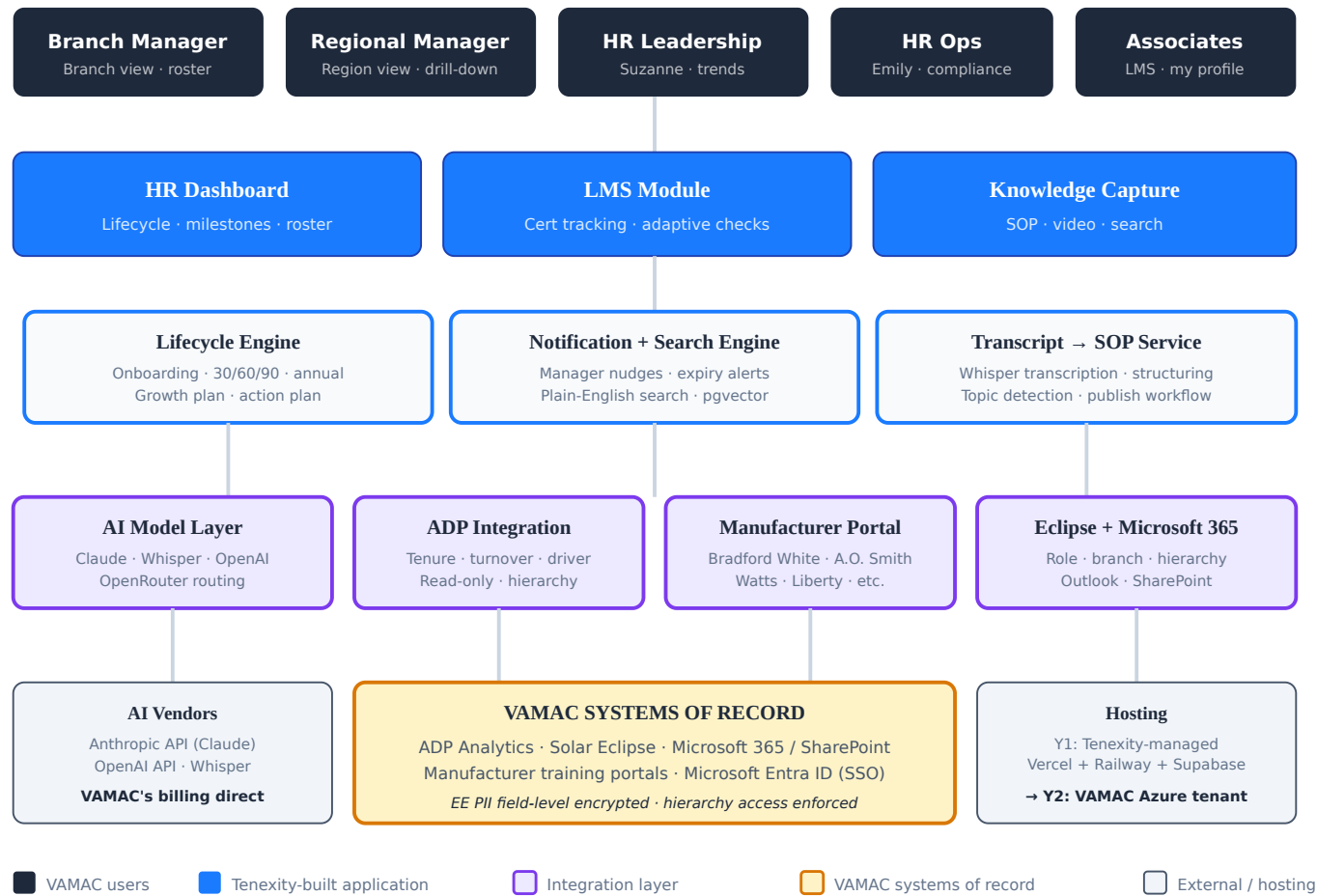
Knowledge Capture flow. Recording captures the full conversation. AI transcribes and structures it into draft SOPs by topic — pricing logic for water-treatment systems, the rebate-tier conversation, the brine-tank passivation handoff. Each draft is anchored to specific moments in the recording. Suzanne reviews, edits, and publishes. The SOPs become searchable across the organization. Knowledge that was about to retire stays.

A NOTE ON WHAT THE AI DOES NOT DO

No predictive at-risk model in Phase 1 (Phase 2). No automated decisions about associates. No surveillance pattern. The platform tracks completion of required certifications and assigned training — same as paper does today, with better visibility. Anything beyond that (predictive insights, retention modeling) is opt-in and reviewed with HR + legal.

SYSTEM ARCHITECTURE

How the pieces fit, and what's shared with septic.



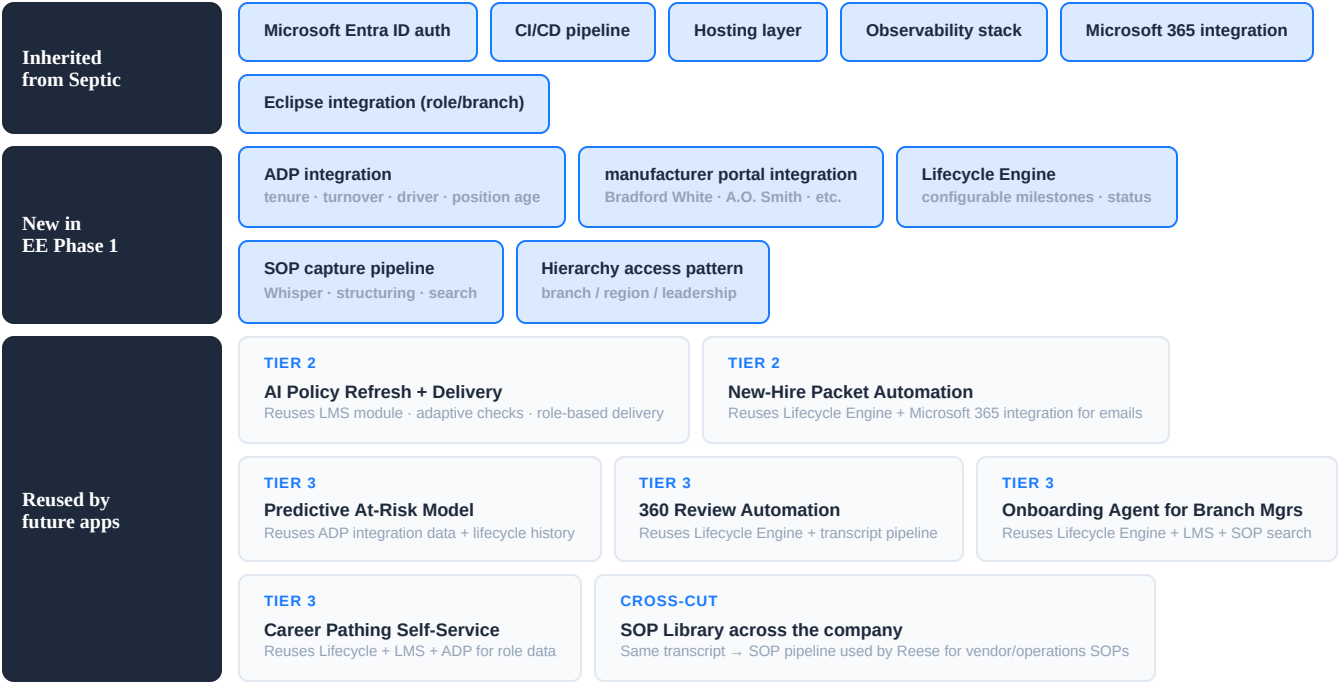
WHAT'S SHARED WITH THE SEPTIC BUILD

Identity (Microsoft Entra ID), hosting (Vercel/Railway/Supabase Year 1, Azure Year 2), CI/CD pipeline, observability stack, Eclipse integration (for role/branch hierarchy), Microsoft 365 integration. New for EE: ADP integration, manufacturer portal integration, Lifecycle Engine, transcript-to-SOP pipeline. Building both unlocks shared infrastructure and reduces total cost.

THE FOUNDATION LAYER

What this build adds to the foundation. What plugs in next.

EE Phase 1 inherits much of the foundation from septic (auth, hosting, CI/CD, observability, Microsoft 365 integration, Eclipse integration for hierarchy data). It contributes new pieces that future HR-adjacent and people-adjacent applications will reuse — the ADP integration, the manufacturer portal connectors, the Lifecycle Engine, and the SOP/transcript pipeline. Below is the foundation map, the way it grows over time.



WHY THIS IS THE RIGHT SECOND BUILD, NOT FIRST

If EE were the first build, the cost would be roughly the same as Septic — \$45–55K — because it would carry the full foundation cost. Sequencing it second drops Phase 1 to ~\$35K because the foundation work is amortized. Either way, the platform itself accumulates: by the end of Phase 1 of both builds, VAMAC has Eclipse, ADP, M365, manufacturer portals, and three working integrations in production.

PHASE 1 SCOPE

Three modules. One platform. Built around how VAMAC develops people.

1

HR Dashboard

Lifecycle-aware. Manager view + leadership view. Milestones across the associate journey. Pulls from ADP, certification tracking, and training data.

2

Learning Management

Cert tracking with expiry alerts. Hierarchy access. Manufacturer training links. Adaptive AI knowledge checks. Eclipse-aware role assignment.

3

Knowledge Capture

Interview transcripts → searchable SOPs. AI suggests SOP edits. Short-form video catalog. Personalized by role and tenure.

- **HR Dashboard · Manager view.** Each branch and regional manager sees their team's lifecycle status — onboarding, 30/60/90 reviews, certifications current/overdue, growth plan progress, action plans, PTO calendar, items due (CPR, driver qualifications, random testing). The "items due" surface Suzanne specified, exactly.
- **HR Dashboard · Leadership view.** Suzanne and HR leadership see trends across regions and branches — turnover, time-to-productive, certification compliance rate, growth-plan completion, training completion. Drills down to the branch and the individual when needed. Audit log on every drill-down.
- **LMS · Certification tracking.** Forklift, CPR, compliance, branch-specific certs — all in one place. Expiry alerts at 90/60/30 days. Auto-created renewal tasks for managers. Hierarchy access enforced (Emily sees everyone, regionals see their region, branch managers see their branch).
- **LMS · Manufacturer training integration.** The thing BlueVolt couldn't do. Direct links into manufacturer training portals (Bradford White, A.O. Smith for Phase 1; expandable from there). Completion data flows back. Certificates auto-filed and recognized. New manufacturer modules auto-route to associates carrying that product line.
- **LMS · Adaptive AI knowledge checks.** Per Lauren's Apr 19 note — "AI that asks questions back inside the program." Knowledge checks that adapt to the learner's tenure and role. Reduces compliance theater, increases actual retention. Tracked against cert renewals.
- **Knowledge Capture · SOP from transcripts.** Sit with a senior associate or branch manager for 60 minutes. The platform turns the recording into a draft SOP. SME reviews and approves. Searchable across the organization. Captures what walks out the door at retirement.
- **Knowledge Capture · Short-form video library.** Lauren's "here's a faucet, here's how you solve it" library. Tagged by product, role, branch, customer type. Searchable in plain English. Personalized recommendations based on what the associate has worked on this week.
- **Notification engine.** Daily digest emails to managers. Weekly leadership digest to Suzanne. Cert-expiry sequences. Onboarding milestone reminders. All delivered through M365 — no separate notification system to manage.
- **Mobile-friendly UI.** Branch managers checking in from the field, associates completing training on a tablet, Suzanne reviewing on a tablet — all the same app, responsive design.

WHAT'S NOT IN PHASE 1

Predictive insights (at-risk associate, stalled development) — Phase 2 once 6+ months of dashboard data exists. Automated manager nudges and recommendations — Phase 2. Full performance-improvement-plan workflow — Phase 2. Self-service career-pathing portal — Phase 3.

INTEGRATION DEEP DIVE

ADP, manufacturer portals, and Eclipse — the pieces that make this work.

EE Phase 1 needs three integrations that septic does not. The ADP integration, the manufacturer portal integration, and an extension to the Eclipse integration for branch and role hierarchy. Each is read-only or scoped-write with full audit logging. Below is the contract for each.

ADP integration Server

Capability	What it reads	What it writes	Why it matters
Tenure	Hire date · current role · role change history	(read-only)	Lifecycle milestones · 30/60/90 anchors
Position metadata	Position age · role hierarchy · reporting chain	(read-only)	Manager view roster · region rollups
Driver data	License status · medical card · DOT cert expiry	(read-only)	Compliance dashboard · cert sequencing
Turnover signals	Termination date + reason · last-day-worked	(read-only)	Leadership view trend reporting

manufacturer portal integration

Capability	Phase 1 Vendors	Reads	Action
Course catalog	Bradford White · A.O. Smith · Watts	Available courses · prerequisites · expiry rules	Auto-route new modules to associates carrying those product lines
Completion records	Same	Associate completion · timestamps · cert PDFs	Sync to LMS module · file completion records to SharePoint
Enrollment	Same	(write — enrollment via portal API where available)	Manager initiates enrollment from LMS · system handles portal interaction

Phase 1 starts with 2–3 manufacturers (highest-volume product lines). The adapter pattern means each additional manufacturer is a low-effort add — typically 1–2 days per portal. Phase 2 expands to the long tail.

Eclipse integration — extension for hierarchy

Septic uses Eclipse for inventory, pricing, and customer data. EE uses it for the role, branch, and region hierarchy that drives access control. Same integration; new query surface added (read-only). The hierarchy data is what makes "branch managers see their branch only" enforceable at the API level — not just at the UI level.

Why the integration pattern matters for HR data specifically

EE PII is more sensitive than financial data — termination reasons, performance histories, growth plans. The defined-integration pattern matters more here, not less. Robert can read the entire ADP integration and verify exactly what fields are exposed and to whom. No agent has open ADP credentials. No tool can pull a list of "everyone with low growth-plan completion in their first year" without going through the integration's hierarchy-aware access controls.

Field-level encryption on PII at the database layer. Hierarchy access enforced at the API layer. Audit log of every read. Data export available at any point in standard relational schema. SOC 2 Type 2 readiness pattern throughout.

DEVELOPMENT PROCESS

The build process, sprint by sprint.

Same 1-week sprint cadence as septic. Every sprint ships something visible. Below is the build pattern across 8–10 weeks. Note: if both flagship builds run in parallel, the foundation work in weeks 1–2 is shared between them — that's the source of the cost efficiency.

SPRINTS 1–2

W01–W02

Foundation + ADP First

If septic running first: foundation already in place. If EE running first or in parallel: GitHub org, Entra ID, hosting, CI/CD, observability all stand up in weeks 1–2. ADP integration skeleton with first read query (tenure data). Manager view UX wireframe approved by Suzanne.

Foundation operationalADP first querySuzanne UX sessionADP credentials

SPRINT 3

W03

Manager View Live · Real ADP Data

HR Dashboard manager view live with real ADP data flowing. Cert tracking module functional. Lifecycle Engine v1 with onboarding milestones. Demo to Suzanne + 2 regional managers.

Manager view liveCert tracking moduleRegional manager review

SPRINT 4

W04

Lifecycle Engine + SOP Capture v1

Lifecycle Engine completes — onboarding, 30/60/90, annual, growth/action plan. SOP capture from transcript v1 — first associate interview. Whisper transcription pipeline tuned.

Lifecycle EngineSOP capture v1First senior assoc interview

SPRINT 5

W05

Manufacturer Integration · Adaptive Checks

Bradford White + A.O. Smith manufacturer portal integrations live. Knowledge check engine v1 — adaptive questioning based on role. Leadership view (Suzanne) takes shape.

Manufacturer integrationsAdaptive checksManufacturer credentials

SPRINT 6

W06

End-to-End · Robert Security Review

End-to-end manager workflow live. Real associate data flowing. Cert renewal tasks auto-creating. Robert formal security review — ADP integration scopes, hierarchy access, PII handling. Mid-build review with Suzanne + Emily + Scott.

End-to-end liveRobert IT signoffLeadership demoSecurity review

SPRINT 7

W07

Notifications · Hypercare Prep

Notification engine. Daily digests. Performance hardening. Training materials. Regional managers training session (90 min).

Notification engineTraining materialsRegional training

SPRINTS 8–9

W08–W09

Pilot Launch · Hypercare

Pilot launch with 2 regions. Real managers using it for real associates. Daily standups week 1. Bug fixes from live load.

MVP in production2 regions livePilot region full participation

SPRINT 10

W10

Phase 2 Scoping · Full Rollout

Phase 1 retrospective. Phase 2 SOW drafted (predictive at-risk, automated nudges, performance workflow). Documentation handoff. Full company rollout decision.

Phase 1 completePhase 2 SOWPhase 2 commitment

THE OPERATING MODEL

VAMAC owns everything. Tenexity drives delivery and is responsible for it.

The ownership model is simple. **VAMAC owns the platform** — the code, the data, the integrations, the operating knowledge, the production system, and the relationships with every vendor (Anthropic, OpenAI, Vercel, Railway, Supabase, GitHub, Microsoft Azure) from day one. Tenexity is **assisting VAMAC and is responsible for driving the work to delivery**. We are accountable for the build shipping on time, on scope, and at the quality bar this engagement deserves. Below is the explicit split for EE: what VAMAC does, what Tenexity does, and what we share.

AREA	WHAT VAMAC DOES	WHAT TENEXITY DOES	WHAT'S SHARED
Product design	Suzanne is the product owner · defines lifecycle milestones · approves dashboard structure · sets cert tracking rules · Emily owns LMS curriculum	UX execution · prototyping · UI build · responsible for the product working for users	Tuesday HR working group
Source code	Owns the repository · branch protection · approves who has access	Writes the Phase 1 code · responsible for quality and delivery	Code review on every pull request
Architecture	Approves the architectural direction	Designs the architecture · documents every decision	Joint design review sessions in weeks 1–3
ADP integration	Provides ADP credentials · approves access scope · Suzanne validates field-level access	Builds and maintains the integration · responsible for it working	Joint testing in weeks 3–6
Manufacturer portal integration	Provides vendor credentials · Emily prioritizes which portals come first	Builds the integration per portal · responsible for it working	Phase 1 covers 2–3 vendors
Microsoft 365 integration	Provides M365 admin access · approves the app registration	Builds the integration for filing, email, and identity	Robert reviews and signs off
Eclipse integration (hierarchy)	Approves the role and branch hierarchy access pattern	Extends the existing Eclipse integration for hierarchy data	Shared with the septic build
Security review · PII handling	Robert leads · Tier 2 review · sign-off authority before production	Threat modeling · remediation · field-level encryption · audit log design	Week 2 first review · Week 6 formal review
Senior associate interviews	Suzanne and Emily identify SMEs · schedule sessions · approve SOP drafts before publication	Conducts the interviews alongside · runs the transcript pipeline · drafts SOPs	First interview co-led in week 4
HR data classification	Determines what each level sees — associate vs. manager vs. regional vs. leadership	Builds and enforces the hierarchy access pattern at the API layer	Joint review with HR and IT
Hosting + infrastructure	Owns billing relationships from day one with every vendor	Manages day-to-day during Year 1 · responsible for uptime	Year 2 migration to VAMAC Azure
Production deploys	Final approval gate · production access controlled by VAMAC	Deploy execution · hypercare · responsible for the deploy working	Manual approval workflow in CI/CD
End-user training	Delivers training to additional regions as rollout expands · operates the LMS day-to-day	Trains the trainers · creates training materials	Pilot region session co-led
Operating + monitoring	First-line user support · Tier 1 issue triage by Year 2	P0 / P1 on-call · architectural fixes · responsible for the system staying up	Monitoring tools accessible to both teams

WHAT SUZANNE AND EMILY WILL BE DOING SPECIFICALLY

Suzanne is the product owner — ~4 hrs/week. Tuesday HR working group, Friday review, async ad-hoc. She owns "what does the dashboard show" and "what milestones matter." Emily is the LMS subject matter expert — ~2 hrs/week. She owns "what certs we track" and "what manufacturer portals come first." Both are co-designers, not approvers of a finished thing. The product reflects what HR actually needs because HR is in the room.

WHAT TENEXITY STANDS UP

Every element of the platform, who provisions it, when it's ready.

Tenexity is responsible for standing up every element below — under VAMAC's ownership and billing relationships. If EE runs in parallel with the septic build, the foundation work (Entra ID, hosting, CI/CD, observability, Microsoft 365 integration, Eclipse integration) happens once across both. If EE runs sequentially after septic, weeks 1–2 are dedicated to the ADP and manufacturer portal integrations and the dashboard prototype.

The elements that get stood up

ELEMENT	WHAT IT IS	WHO PROVISIONS	WHEN LIVE
GitHub Organization	VAMAC-owned org · branch protection · code-owners file · Tenexity engineers added as collaborators	VAMAC owns · Tenexity sets up	Day 2–3
Microsoft Entra ID	App registrations for EE · hierarchy-based group claims · conditional access policies inherited	Robert provisions	Day 4
Hosting accounts	Vercel (frontend) · Railway (backend) · Supabase (Postgres) — VAMAC owns the billing, Tenexity manages day-to-day. Shared with septic if both engaged.	VAMAC owns billing · Tenexity manages	Day 5
CI / CD pipeline	GitHub Actions · automated tests on every commit · staging deploy on merge · production deploy with explicit approval	Tenexity	Day 6
Observability stack	Error monitoring · performance monitoring · LLM cost dashboards · on-call alerting	Tenexity	Day 7
AI vendor accounts	Anthropic Team subscription · OpenAI Enterprise (already at VAMAC) · OpenRouter for routing · Whisper for transcription — all under VAMAC billing	VAMAC owns · Tenexity assists with setup	Day 1–7
ADP integration	Connection to ADP Analytics · scoped read access · field-level encryption on PII at the database layer · full audit logging	Suzanne + Robert provision access · Tenexity builds	Day 8–14
Microsoft 365 integration	SharePoint filing for completion certificates · Outlook for notifications and digests · audited end-to-end	Robert provisions access · Tenexity builds	Day 8–14
Manufacturer portal integration	First 2–3 portals (Bradford White, A.O. Smith, plus one) · course catalog read · completion records sync · enrollment where supported	Emily prioritizes · Tenexity builds	Week 5
Eclipse integration (hierarchy)	Extension of the existing Eclipse integration · adds role, branch, and region hierarchy data for access control	Reese + Evan validate · Tenexity extends	Day 8–14
Lifecycle Engine	Configurable milestone framework · onboarding · 30/60/90 · annual · growth-plan · action-plan · custom checkpoints	Tenexity builds · Suzanne configures	Week 4
Transcript pipeline	Whisper transcription · structuring to draft SOPs · publish workflow · search index	Tenexity	Week 4
First dashboard UI	Manager view scaffold deployed to staging · authentication flowing · stub data · first end-to-end mock	Tenexity	Day 11–14
Documentation	Architecture diagram · integration contracts · runbook · access patterns · PII handling document · onboarding guide for VAMAC IT	Tenexity · updated as we build	Day 1 onward

WHERE SUZANNE SITS IN THIS

Suzanne is the product owner — she sees the manager view UX before code is written. She approves the lifecycle milestone list (which milestones matter, in what order). She gives the green light on what data appears on the dashboard. Her time investment in week 1 is high (~6 hrs); it tapers to ~3 hrs/week steady state.

WHERE ROBERT SITS IN THIS

Robert reviews the EE security architecture in week 2. The ADP integration scopes, the hierarchy access enforcement, the PII encryption pattern, the audit log design — all reviewed and signed off before integration code. The formal week 6 IT review is the final gate. PII concerns get explicit attention: associate data is handled with more care than financial data.

CO-BUILD · HANDS-ON

Helping VAMAC team members start using AI in the product dev sequence.

One of the explicit goals from the March 13 conversation with Robert was that VAMAC develops its own AI applications. That goal is not achieved by Phase 1 ending — it is achieved by VAMAC team members being hands-on through the build, using the same tools Tenexity uses, on the same codebase, with paced ownership transfer. Below is the explicit plan for how each person who wants to be involved gets there.

Who this is for

For the engineering side: Evan, Robert, Nicole, Tasean — VAMAC IT — plus anyone they want to bring in. Equipped with Cursor, Claude Code, GitHub Copilot (already at VAMAC), and Anthropic Team seats. The goal is hands-on with the codebase.

For the product-owner side: Suzanne and Emily — and any other team member who wants to build a Cowork workflow or a Tier 1 internal tool. No code required. Equipped with Claude Team, Cowork desktop, and the patterns from the EE product itself.

The progression — by week and month

WEEK 1 Tool Setup

Get the tools running locally.

IT installs Cursor IDE, configures Claude Code CLI, activates the Anthropic Team subscription seat. VAMAC IT clones the EE repository, runs the application locally, edits a comment, runs tests. Suzanne and Emily install Claude Cowork and walk through the EE product wireframes in Claude Projects.

WEEK 2 First Pairing

Architecture walk-through and the first paired session.

Joint architecture session with Graham — Evan sees how the EE codebase is structured, how the ADP integration is wired, how the deploy pipeline runs. First 90-minute paired-programming session in Cursor with a Tenexity engineer. Goal is comfort with the codebase, not shipping code yet. Robert reviews the security architecture in parallel.

WEEKS 3–4 Active Reviewing

In every PR. Asking the real questions.

VAMAC IT reviews every pull request — not rubber-stamping, but actually reading the change, asking questions, surfacing concerns. By end of week 4, the team knows where every part of the codebase lives. Suzanne and Emily start using Cowork for day-to-day work — drafting policy updates, building cert-renewal workflows.

MONTH 2 First Contributions

Evan ships his first PR. Suzanne ships her first Cowork workflow.

First IT PR — typically a small feature, polish item, or doc update. Tenexity reviews carefully and gives detailed feedback. Suzanne ships her first Cowork workflow for an actual HR process (e.g., onboarding checklist automation). Both prove the loop: scope → build → ship → use.

MONTHS 3–4 Owning a Module

A discrete piece of the EE build, owned by VAMAC IT.

The best first ownership is a manufacturer portal integration — well-scoped, repeatable pattern, real production value. Tenexity supervises and reviews, but the design and the code are Evan's (or whoever takes the lead). Suzanne and Emily lead their own SOP-capture sessions, including the model-prompt tuning.

MONTHS 5–6 Independent Production

A Tier 1 production deploy without Tenexity in the room.

VAMAC IT runs a production deploy independently — Tenexity is on call but increasingly off the critical path. First small internal tool built end-to-end by VAMAC IT (e.g., an internal HR notification utility or a Phocas dashboard generator). Tenexity reviews architectural decisions; the work is yours.

MONTHS 7–12 Co-Building Phase 2

VAMAC IT leads. Tenexity advises.

By Phase 2, VAMAC IT pairs with Tenexity on every new build — predictive at-risk model, onboarding agent, expanded manufacturer coverage. VAMAC IT owns the design conversations; Tenexity owns architecture review and complex problem-solving. The mode shifts from "Tenexity builds, VAMAC observes" to "VAMAC builds, Tenexity advises."

WHAT THIS IS NOT

A training course. There is no LMS module that makes someone capable of running an AI engineering function. The skill builds the way it builds in any engineering team — by doing the work alongside someone who has done it before. Phase 1 is roughly 10 weeks; the broader hands-on arc runs across the full 12 months. By the end, every team member who wanted to be involved has shipped real code, used the real tools, and made decisions that ship to production.

THE BUILD · 8-10 WEEKS · PHASE 1

Working dashboard in front of Suzanne and a regional manager by Week 3.

Every week is shippable. Milestones marked in accent. Time commitment in the right column.

WK	OUR WORKING SESSIONS	WHAT WE BUILD	WHAT VAMAC PROVIDES	YOUR TIME
W01	Kickoff with Suzanne + Emily + Scott. ADP Analytics walkthrough.	Repo · Entra ID · ADP adapter · cert schema · UX wireframe.	ADP credentials · cert tracking files · regional org chart.	~5 HRS
W02	Suzanne dashboard concept session. Emily cert review.	HR Dashboard manager + leadership views live (stub data). Cert tracking module functional.	Suzanne 90 min · Emily 90 min · regional manager 60 min.	~5 HRS
W03	Prototype demo to Suzanne + 2 regional managers.	Working prototype on real ADP data. Manager view fully functional. LMS cert module on real data.	Regional manager review.	~3 HRS
W04	Lifecycle engine session. SOP capture flow review.	Onboarding / 30/60/90 / annual review milestones. SOP capture from transcript v1.	First senior associate interview (90 min).	~3 HRS
W05	Manufacturer portal integration kickoff.	Bradford White + A.O. Smith integration. Knowledge check engine v1.	Manufacturer credentials.	~3 HRS
W06	Mid-build review · Robert security review.	End-to-end manager workflow live. Real data flowing. Cert renewal tasks auto-created.	Leadership demo · UX signoff · Robert review.	~3 HRS
W07	Hypercare prep · regional training.	Notification engine. Daily digest. Performance hardening. Training materials.	Regional training (90 min).	~3 HRS
W08	Pilot launch with 2 regions.	MVP in production. Real managers using it for real associates.	Pilot region full participation.	~5 HRS
W09	Hypercare daily standups. Friday review.	Bug fixes. Adoption tracking. Performance under load.	Region surfaces issues.	~2 HRS
W10	Phase 1 retrospective · Phase 2 scoping.	Phase 1 complete. Full company rollout decision. Documentation handoff. Phase 2 SOW.	Phase 2 commitment.	~4 HRS

FOUR MILESTONES. Manager view · prototype on real data · end-to-end · MVP.

YOUR TOTAL TIME ~36 HRS across 10 weeks

INVESTMENT · BUILD COST

Phase 1 fixed. Phase 2 scoped. Phase 3 iterative.

Phase 1 covers the three modules at MVP — HR Dashboard, LMS, and Knowledge Capture — plus the integrations new to EE (ADP, manufacturer portals, and the Eclipse hierarchy extension). Phase 2 layers predictive insights, automated manager nudges, and richer reporting. Phase 3 is iterative — we will discover additional opportunities as the platform runs.

PHASE	TIMELINE	INVESTMENT	WHAT'S IN	DECISION
PHASE 1	Months 1–3 · 8–10 weeks	\$65,000	HR Dashboard (manager + leadership views) · Lifecycle Engine · LMS with certification tracking · Manufacturer portal integration (2–3 vendors) · Adaptive AI knowledge checks · Knowledge Capture (transcript → SOP, short-form video library, plain-English search) · Notification engine · Pilot launch + hypercare. Includes the integrations new to EE — ADP, manufacturer portals, and the Eclipse hierarchy extension.	Signature now
PHASE 2	Months 4–7	\$35,000 – \$40,000	Predictive intelligence + automation. At-risk associate model · stalled development flagging · automated manager nudges · performance improvement workflow · onboarding agent for branch managers · expanded manufacturer portal coverage (long tail). Scoped precisely after Phase 1 reveals what is needed.	Confirmed end of Phase 1
PHASE 3	Months 8–24 · iterative	Iterative · scoped feature-by-feature	We will discover additional opportunities as the platform runs. Candidates include: - Self-service career pathing · associates see their development path and qualify for new roles - External partner training portal · customers and vendors training alongside associates - Compensation lifecycle integration · pay-band visibility tied to growth-plan completion 360 review automation · structured peer feedback at every review cycle - Advanced analytics tied to branch P&Ls · workforce productivity by branch and region - ATS integration for hiring · candidate pipeline through to onboarding in one flow	Scoped from Phase 1 + 2

Why \$65K for Phase 1

Three considerations. **This is three modules, not one.** HR Dashboard with manager and leadership views, LMS with certification tracking and adaptive checks, and Knowledge Capture with transcript-to-SOP and short-form video — each is its own product, and they share a lifecycle data backbone. **EE-specific integrations are net new.** ADP integration with PII handling and hierarchy access. Manufacturer portal integrations for 2–3 vendors (Bradford White, A.O. Smith, plus one). Eclipse extended for role and branch hierarchy. **The result is portable.** Source code, data, and operating knowledge are yours from day one. Architecture is built to be picked up by any qualified team or by VAMAC IT directly.

BUNDLED OFFER · BOTH FLAGSHIPS ENGAGED TOGETHER

\$140K combined (\$75K Septic + \$65K EE) gets both flagship platforms in production within 12 weeks, sharing a single foundation. We also include the month-end close automation using Claude Cowork at no additional charge. Detailed in the Operating Model document.

Compared to buying SaaS

SAP SuccessFactors, Workday Learning, or a stack of point tools (BambooHR + Lessonly + Bridge + transcript-to-doc) lands at \$50–\$120 per user per month at VAMAC's scale — \$107–\$258K annually for 179 associates. None of them solve the manufacturer-training-link problem that BlueVolt failed at, and none produce a search-ready SOP corpus from interview transcripts. Build cost amortizes across 24+ months at meaningfully less total spend, with a tool purpose-built for VAMAC.

OPERATING COST · TENEXITY-HOSTED → VAMAC-HOSTED

What it costs to run, as the platform moves to your environment.

Same three-stage model as septic. Year 1: VAMAC sets up the hosting accounts under VAMAC billing; Tenexity runs the platform through go-live. Year 2: migration to VAMAC's Azure tenant, Tenexity continues operational management. Year 3+: VAMAC IT runs day-to-day, Tenexity advisory only.

YEAR 1 · PRE-LIVE

Tenexity Runs It

Where it runs: Vercel + Railway + Supabase. Accounts set up by VAMAC under VAMAC billing in Week 1, Tenexity admins added.

Who runs it: Tenexity through go-live. That's our job in Phase 1. Named onshore support. P0 same-day.

What VAMAC pays: Hosting bills to vendors directly + AI usage (~\$200–400/mo). Tenexity operating support included in Phase 1 through go-live.

[Actual review at go-live](#)

YEAR 2

VAMAC Azure

Where it runs: Migrated to VAMAC's Azure tenant.

Who runs it: Tenexity primary. Evan + IT shadow on production deploys.

What VAMAC pays: Azure hosting (~\$200–350/mo combined). Tenexity operating retainer: \$1,250/mo.

\$19,000/yr · all-in

YEAR 3+

VAMAC-Operated

Where it runs: VAMAC Azure. No change.

Who runs it: Internal VAMAC IT runs day-to-day. Tenexity advisory only.

What VAMAC pays: Azure hosting (steady-state). Tenexity reduced retainer: \$1,000/mo or less.

\$15,000/yr · trending down

If both flagships run, hosting is shared

The Vercel/Railway/Supabase environment in Year 1 hosts both septic and EE under one account. Same for Azure migration in Year 2. The cost figures above assume EE in isolation. **Combined Year 1 hosting for both flagship platforms: ~\$8K/yr platform vendors**, not \$5K + \$4.5K = \$9.5K. Combined Year 2: ~\$36K all-in (vs. \$42K standalone). The compounding savings are why we recommend running them together.

Year 2 migration — what's involved

~4–6 weeks of migration work for EE alone (or shared with septic if migrating both at once). Standing up the Azure environment. Migrating the Postgres database (no schema changes). Switching SSO endpoints. Performance validation. Cutover. Tenexity executes; VAMAC IT shadows. Cost: ~\$12K, scoped from Phase 1 learnings, paid Year 2 not Year 1. Built into the Year 2 figure above.

A NOTE ON PII AND MIGRATION

EE handles employee PII; the Year 2 migration to Azure brings the entire data set into VAMAC's tenant. From that point, no employee data resides outside your tenant boundary except in transit to AI providers (under their zero-data-retention enterprise configurations). This is the right end-state for SOC 2 Type 2 alignment and matches what Robert outlined on March 13.

Risk Register

R1	RISK Manager adoption lags — too much like Epicor LMS rework.	HOW WE HANDLE IT Regional managers in the design from week 2. UX co-designed with users. Pilot at 2 regions before full rollout. Previous tools failed because the workflow didn't fit; this one is built around it.
R2	RISK EE PII handling — branch managers seeing data they shouldn't.	HOW WE HANDLE IT Hierarchy access enforced at every API call. Field-level encryption on PII. Full audit log. Robert reviews access design at week 2 and week 6.
R3	RISK Manufacturer portal integrations vary in quality.	HOW WE HANDLE IT Phase 1 includes 2–3 manufacturer integrations. Adapter pattern means each new manufacturer is a low-effort add. We start with high-volume; long tail follows on a known timeline.
R4	RISK SOP corpus from transcripts produces low-quality drafts initially.	HOW WE HANDLE IT Drafts always reviewed by SME before publishing. Model improves with feedback. We don't rely on AI to be the SOP author — it produces a strong draft saving the SME 80% of the time.
R5	RISK Tenexity has a setback.	HOW WE HANDLE IT Source code yours from day one. Transition plan in the SOW. 60–90 day wind-down clause. Architecture portable to any qualified team or to VAMAC IT directly.

ANTICIPATED QUESTIONS

Anticipated questions and answers.

How is this different from Workday or BambooHR?

Those are HRIS systems. We are not replacing your HRIS — ADP stays. We are building the layer on top: lifecycle dashboards, LMS that handles manufacturer training links the way BlueVolt could not, and knowledge capture that turns institutional memory into searchable content.

What happens to the data if we end the relationship?

Source code yours from day one. Data export available at any point — CSV, JSON, full database snapshot. No proprietary format. The platform keeps running on infrastructure you control. 60–90 day wind-down clause.

Can branch managers see their team without seeing other branches?

Yes. Hierarchy-based access enforced at every API call. A branch manager sees their branch. A regional sees their region. Suzanne and HR leadership see everything. Audit log captures every access.

How does Knowledge Capture protect tribal knowledge from being mishandled?

Every interview is consented. Every SOP draft reviewed by the SME before publishing. The corpus is searchable inside VAMAC, never shared externally without explicit approval. Institutional knowledge becomes a VAMAC asset.

What about associates who don't want their training data tracked?

The platform tracks completion status of required certifications and assigned training — same as paper does today. We don't surveil; we provide visibility into compliance. Anything beyond that is opt-in and reviewed with HR + legal.

Will the LMS replace the AI policy training?

It hosts it. The AI policy training (currently not formalized, per Apr 13) becomes a module — delivered by role, with adaptive checks, completion tracked. Policy refresh + delivery can be the first content the LMS hosts.

Can we add custom milestones (e.g., a 6-month review)?

Yes. The lifecycle engine is configurable. Suzanne owns the milestones — onboarding, 30/60/90, custom checkpoints, annual, growth-plan stages. Add or modify them through the admin UI without engineering involvement.

How does this connect to Septic Tank Takeoff?

Both share the same platform foundation — auth, hosting, deployment pipeline. Building one accelerates the other. The Knowledge Capture module also feeds septic's training material — counter associates training on the takeoff tool gets a direct content channel.

What if we want to start with just one module — say, the LMS?

Possible but not recommended. The three modules share the lifecycle data model; building one in isolation forces compromises that show up later. Better to phase the rollout: Phase 1 of all three modules at MVP, with deeper features (e.g., predictive insights) coming in Phase 2.

Manufacturer portals — what if our list grows?

Adapter pattern handles it. Each new portal is 1–2 days of work. Phase 1 covers 2–3; Phase 2 expands to the rest. Common manufacturer portals (Bradford White, A.O. Smith, Watts, Liberty) are well-documented; uncommon ones may need a customer-portal scrape pattern instead.

WHAT'S NEXT

From here to a working tool.

01.

THIS WEEK

Confirm scope and team fit.

Walk through this document with Suzanne, Emily, Scott, Evan, and Robert. Identify the product owner. Confirm pilot regions. Tenexity answers any open questions on data flow, manager UX, and PII handling.
02.

WITHIN 5 BUSINESS DAYS

Statement of Work signed.

Detailed SOW with fixed Phase 1 scope, the support and maintenance schedule on Page 13, the team commitments on Page 9, the transition path. Same legal structure as the Mar 13 NDA framework. Tenexity completes Robert's DDQ in parallel.
03.

WEEK OF MAY 18

Discovery starts. Build clock starts.

Working sessions with Suzanne and Emily. ADP Analytics walkthrough. Manager prototype in front of users by week 3. MVP in production with 2 regions by week 8. Then we keep going.

The next move is yours.

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Graham Walker · graham@tenexity.ai
Lauren Thacker · lauren.thacker@tenexity.ai

From 10% to 10× with Tenexity.

END OF MAIN PROPOSAL · APPENDIX FOLLOWS

Appendix.

Tenexity Engagement Standards. The parts of every Tenexity build that do not change from one client to the next — the multi-model engineering stack we use, the per-service platform license estimates, and the team you work with. Included identically across both flagship proposals.

WHAT'S IN THIS APPENDIX

A1

Multi-Model Agentic Engineering

Claude Code, Codex, Cursor, GitHub Copilot, Claude Cowork, Replit Agent — how Tenexity builds and how VAMAC operates.

A2

Platform License Estimates

Per-service monthly cost estimates for every platform vendor VAMAC engages directly. Hosting framing.

A3

The Tenexity Team

Nick, Graham, and Lauren — bios and the Mon–Fri operating cadence.

THE ENGINEERING STACK

Multi-model agentic engineering.

Modern AI engineering does not run on one model or one tool. Different models have different strengths — Claude reasons deeply about long-context problems and writes excellent code; OpenAI's models excel at structured data transformations and have a different style of failure that catches things Claude misses. We use both, in parallel, and we route work to whichever is best suited. The same multi-model approach is what VAMAC's IT team will operate on — every engineer ends up using all of these tools daily, and the redundancy across vendors is part of the resilience pattern.

The tools we use, and how each gets integrated

Claude Code

Anthropic

AGENTIC CLI · PRIMARY

What it does. Agentic CLI that reads the codebase, plans changes across multiple files, writes code, runs tests, fixes errors, and commits. The most powerful tool in the stack for substantial engineering work — anywhere from a multi-file refactor to building an entire feature from a spec.

HOW TENEXITY USES IT

Daily driver in build sprints. The majority of Phase 1 code is written with Claude Code in the loop.

HOW VAMAC OPERATES WITH IT

Evan, Robert, Nicole, and Tasean get Claude Code seats Day 1. Pair with Tenexity engineers in Week 2. By Month 6, IT ships internal tools using Claude Code as the primary tool.

Codex

OpenAI

AGENTIC CLI · SECONDARY

What it does. OpenAI's agentic coding CLI. Different reasoning style and different strengths than Claude Code. We use it as a second opinion — when Claude Code's approach isn't landing, Codex often sees a different solution.

HOW TENEXITY USES IT

For specific problem types — data-shape transformations, certain test-generation patterns — Codex outperforms. We route to it consciously. Also our vendor redundancy: if Anthropic has an outage, we keep shipping.

HOW VAMAC OPERATES WITH IT

Available alongside Claude Code on the same workstations. Same usage pattern. VAMAC's existing OpenAI Enterprise relationship makes provisioning trivial.

Cursor IDE

Anyphere

AGENTIC IDE · DAILY DRIVER

What it does. A VS Code fork with deep AI integration. Where engineers actually work day-to-day. Claude Code orchestrates; Cursor is the hands-on editing environment. Best-in-class for interactive coding work.

HOW TENEXITY USES IT

Every Tenexity engineer's primary IDE. Most code review happens here.

HOW VAMAC OPERATES WITH IT

3 Cursor Business seats provisioned in Week 1 — Evan and two internal product owners. Same tool, same patterns. VAMAC IT can review every Tenexity PR in Cursor with full AI assistance.

GitHub Copilot

GitHub / Microsoft

INLINE COMPLETION · ALREADY AT VAMAC

What it does. Inline code completion while typing. Already provisioned at VAMAC via Copilot Premium for 15 users since May. Lower-friction than Claude Code for getting started; less powerful for full-feature work.

HOW TENEXITY USES IT

Alongside Cursor and Claude Code — Copilot for autocomplete, Claude Code for the big lifts.

HOW VAMAC OPERATES WITH IT

Continue existing seats. Pairs well with the new tools. Lowest-effort first step for anyone in IT who wants to start writing AI-assisted code today.

Claude Cowork

Anthropic

DESKTOP AGENT · PRODUCT OWNERS

What it does. Desktop application that runs agentic workflows on local files and connected services. The right tool for non-engineering automation — financial workflows, document processing, file-driven tasks. Scott's month-end close runs here.

HOW TENEXITY USES IT

For our own back-office work and for prototyping client workflows before they get formalized into a build engagement.

HOW VAMAC OPERATES WITH IT

Scott, Suzanne, Emily get Cowork seats. The month-end close automation runs here. Suzanne builds HR workflows. Emily automates compliance tasks. No engineering required.

Replit Agent + v0 + Lovable

Replit / Vercel / Lovable

FULL-STACK PROTOTYPING

What it does. Conversational full-stack development — describe what you want, get a working app. Best for "show the steering committee a working demo by Friday." Evan already used Replit Agent at `vamac-platform-demo.replit.app` for the Apr 17 demo.

HOW TENEXITY USES IT

When we need to show a working concept fast — before committing real engineering capital.

HOW VAMAC OPERATES WITH IT

Available for steering committee demos and Tier 1 internal tools. Suzanne or Emily can prototype an internal tool here before deciding whether it warrants the full build process.

WHY MULTI-MODEL MATTERS

Locking onto a single vendor is the slow path. Models leapfrog each other every quarter — what's best today is third-best in six months. The multi-model stack lets VAMAC ride the curve as it moves, instead of paying to migrate every time the leader changes. It's also vendor redundancy: if Anthropic has an outage, the build keeps moving on OpenAI; if OpenAI raises prices, we route the same work through OpenRouter or directly to Anthropic. This is how production engineering teams operate in 2026.

PLATFORM LICENSE ESTIMATES

Per-service monthly costs so VAMAC is clear on what gets paid where.

Below is the platform side of the cost picture — the per-service software licenses VAMAC pays directly. These are separate from the Tenexity build fee and the operating retainer. **Every vendor bills VAMAC, not Tenexity** — VAMAC owns the relationships from Day 1. **Hosting is a separate, VAMAC-paid line** — set up by VAMAC in Week 1, run by Tenexity through go-live, with actual ongoing costs reviewed together once the platform is live.

SERVICE	PLAN	MONTHLY	NOTES
AI MODELS			
Anthropic	Team — 5 seats × \$30	\$150	Scott, Ian, Suzanne, Evan, Robert. Move to Enterprise when audit + SSO needs grow.
Anthropic API	Pay-per-token usage	\$300–500	Build + production usage. Hard-capped per app with 50/80/100% alerts.
OpenAI Enterprise	Already at VAMAC	paid	15 users since May. Continue as-is.
OpenAI API	Pay-per-token usage	\$100–200	Where OpenAI is best fit (data transformations, embeddings, Whisper).
OpenRouter	Pay-as-you-go (small markup)	\$50–100	Routing layer for vendor redundancy + cost control.
Perplexity Pro	5 seats × \$20 (optional)	\$100	For research-heavy roles (David, sales, executives). Optional.
ENGINEERING & CODING			
Cursor	Business — 3 seats × \$40	\$120	Evan + two internal product owners. SSO + admin.
GitHub Copilot	Premium — Already at VAMAC	paid	15 existing seats. Pairs with the new tools.
Linear	Standard — ~6 seats × \$8	\$48	Project + issue tracking. Shared between Tenexity and VAMAC IT.
SOURCE CONTROL & CI/CD			
GitHub	Team — ~10 seats × \$4	\$40	Repos + Actions for CI/CD. 3,000 free build minutes/month included.
HOSTING · SET UP BY VAMAC · RUN BY TENEXITY THROUGH GO-LIVE			
Vercel	Pro + usage · VAMAC account	reviewed at go-live	Frontend hosting. Year 2 migrates to Azure App Service.
Railway	Pro + compute usage · VAMAC account	reviewed at go-live	Backend services. Year 2 migrates to Azure Container Apps.
Supabase	Pro · VAMAC account	reviewed at go-live	PostgreSQL + auth + storage. Year 2 migrates to Azure Database.
OBSERVABILITY & OPS			
Sentry	Team — 50K events	\$26	Error tracking + performance monitoring.
LangFuse	Cloud Pro	\$59	LLM observability — every prompt, every token cost, per-app dashboards.
PagerDuty	Professional — 2 seats × \$25	\$50	On-call alerting. Initially Tenexity carries the pager.
SUBTOTAL · New monthly platform spend	Excludes existing OpenAI + Copilot · Excludes hosting (reviewed at go-live)	\$1,043 – \$1,393	Annual: \$12,516 – \$16,716
Year 1 estimate	All non-hosting platform vendors	~\$15,000/yr	Hard-capped via budget alerts

HOW HOSTING GETS SET UP AND PAID

Hosting is not bundled into the Phase 1 fee. The setup we recommend: **VAMAC creates the Vercel, Railway, and Supabase accounts in Week 1 under VAMAC's own billing** and adds Tenexity engineers as admins. **Tenexity runs the platform through go-live** — that is our job in Phase 1. Once the system is live and processing real workload, we sit down together and review the actual ongoing costs — both the hosting bills and the operational support model — and decide how much VAMAC takes on directly. That way the ongoing cost picture is grounded in real production usage, not estimates.

WHO YOU WORK WITH

Who you'll work with.

NP

Nick Pericle

EXECUTIVE SPONSOR · CEO

Founder & CEO. Previously MD of Distribution at ProfitOptics. NAW Institute Fellow. Co-host of Distribution at the Crossroads. Owns commercial scope and strategic alignment.

GW

Graham Walker

PROJECT LEAD · COO

Co-founder & COO. More than a decade leading technical delivery on platforms more complex than this. Owns architecture, engineering pod direction, code review.

LT

Lauren Thacker

PROJECT MANAGER · PRODUCT

Project Manager and Product Lead. Eight-plus years across distribution and manufacturing. Owns weekly cadence. Particular fit for the HR work; will be in every Tuesday HR Working Group.

ENGINEERING POD

3 to 5 engineers structured around the build. Same engineers for the engagement duration. Surge backup network on standby.